CLIENT BACKGROUND

Research Dossier

Wedding Industry Ads, LLC

Ads • Funnels • LeadLock • The Wedding Industry

August 2026

weddingindustryads.com

Company snapshot

Business name: Wedding Industry Ads, LLC (WIA); operates its software line under the trading name LeadLock.

Type: Boutique digital advertising agency serving the wedding industry exclusively — Google Ads and Meta Ads management paired with a white-labelled lead-management system.

Founded: 2022. The co-founders met in 2020 as both were entering Facebook ads management; the partnership predates the company by two years.

Location: Liberty Hill, Texas (outside Austin); the second principal is based in Lubbock. Registered to the founder's home base in Williamson County.

Operating model: Virtual-first service delivery; no physical office; clients across the United States and internationally.

Scale: Two W-2 employees — the co-founders — supported by a small bench of part-time specialist contractors. Roughly 10–15 full-service clients at any time (about a dozen currently), plus cohorts moving through the Accelerator programmes.

Team identity: An all-women team, stated as a point of pride: "our team of incredible women."

Contact: hello@weddingindustryads.com; Instagram (@weddingindustryads) is the channel they actively monitor — "we mostly hang out on IG."

Core positioning

WIA positions itself beyond ad management: "At WIA, we don't just run ads. We build client acquisition systems." The underlying argument is structural — a wedding client books once and never returns, so consistent lead flow matters more than lifetime value, and the retention-driven playbooks of general marketing do not transfer to this vertical.

Their doctrine is unusually opinionated for a small agency, and consistently repeated:

Anti-organic: "Traditional online marketing strategies don't work for the wedding industry. You don't need a lead magnet. You don't need to build an email list. You don't need more followers."

Anti-directory: "Organic marketing and referrals will only take you so far. Directory listings make it hard to stand out" — paid media positioned against the directories that dominate wedding vendor discovery.

Evergreen advertising: Campaigns framed as always-on infrastructure working "24/7", improving as they collect data, and presented to clients as an ongoing, long-term expense.

The platform pairing: Google and Meta as "the ultimate power couple" — intent capture on search, retargeting and interest targeting on social; each described as materially weaker alone.

Conversions over clicks: One of three named differentiators, alongside industry-specific strategy and a collaborative, non-templated process.

Ads are only half the system: "Advertising is just one piece of the puzzle. A high-converting inquiry funnel is the ticket to maximizing your ROI" — the bridge into LeadLock, and the commercial logic of the whole offer stack.

A recurring emphasis in their messaging: speed and follow-up win the booking. Their product materials cite a Lead Connect study — 78% of customers book with whoever responds first, and same-minute contact can lift conversions up to 391%.

Leadership & brand identity

Co-founder — Whitney Hodges: Based in Liberty Hill, Texas. More than a decade in marketing, selling, and producing luxury events (catering sales) before moving into Meta ads in 2020, initially serving coaches, consultants, and course creators. The primary strategist and the public voice on most client accounts; author of the firm's Investment Guide. A Texas wife and mother. She maintains a separate active practice at whitneyhodges.com as a "Meta Ads & Funnel Strategist."

Co-founder — Daniela Justus: Based in Lubbock, Texas. An artist turned advertiser and self-described serial entrepreneur; Facebook/Instagram ads and funnel strategist and online business consultant. She also runs DEJA — Daniela E. Justus Agency, LLC — her own agency serving course creators and membership brands.

Partnership origin story

The two met in 2020 as both were entering the world of Facebook ads management and have been — in their own recurring phrase — "biz besties" ever since. Whitney worked inside Daniela's agency DEJA before the pair launched Wedding Industry Ads in 2022 as the vertical-specific venture. Their joint bio claims a combined "over 12 years in sales, marketing, event planning, and management," with client work spanning budget-conscious events through weddings exceeding $1 million.

Brand voice & identity

Warm, first-person-plural, and built on wedding vocabulary used as wordplay throughout — Google and Meta are a "match made in heaven" and "the perfect union"; ideal clients "vow to be an active participant." The mission is framed in redistributive terms: "putting more money into the hands of wedding business owners." Visually: a circular serif monogram in brand navy inside an accent-blue ring.

Who they serve (target market)

The published client list spans fourteen categories: venues, wedding planners, destination specialists, officiants, rental companies, bridal attire, photographers, videographers, caterers, stationers, bands, DJs, florists, and wedding industry educators/marketers — "& More!"

In practice, wedding venues are the majority of the client base and carry the flagship case study and most testimonials, with planners, photographers, and entertainers making up the remainder. End buyers are engaged couples — which drives the one-time-buyer economics at the heart of their positioning. For existing clients whose services extend into other event markets, they will run non-wedding campaigns; wedding work is "our clients' bread & butter," not a hard restriction.

What their most successful clients have in common (their own rubric)

They appreciate the work and expertise and trust the process. They don't expect immediate results and understand results compound over time. They are active participants who give feedback. They have done foundational marketing work on their ideal client and unique selling proposition. They are responsive, coachable, ready to take action, and comfortable embracing new technology.

The stated disqualifier is just as clear: they want clients seeking "sustainable growth. Not a quick fix, last ditch effort to save your business." The Investment Guide sets three pre-conditions before any ad spend: a clear, compelling offer; a sales funnel that converts inquiries into bookings; and prior investment in brand and ideal-client definition.

Offer stack (services & products)

A) Elevate — full-service ads management (ongoing retainer)

The done-for-you flagship: Google Ads plus Meta Ads plus the LeadLock funnel behind them — landing pages for the ad traffic and full email/text nurture sequences. Their conviction is that end-to-end control of the chain, from the ad click to what happens after the lead arrives, is what produces results. Most clients invest an average of $2,500/month (services plus ad spend combined; the service fee alone is not broken out). Capacity is deliberately rationed — roughly 10–15 clients at a time, "spots are very limited," entry via waitlist.

B) Ads Accelerators — guided implementation (one-time investment)

A hybrid three-to-six-month engagement combining curriculum, group calls, office hours, and some done-for-you elements: WIA launches the campaigns, and the client learns to take them over. Pricing: $1,997 for the Google Search Accelerator, $1,697 for the Meta Ads Accelerator, or $3,197 for both — the bundle includes six months of guided support. Ad spend is additional; they prescribe a minimum of $500/month for Google, $300–$800/month for Meta, and at least $1,000/month for both platforms together.

The Accelerators evolved from the firm's 2024 "VIP Day" offers — single-day campaign builds at $1,497 (Google) and $1,697 (Meta), sold one or two spots per month. In the repackaging, the Google price rose by a third while Meta held flat.

C) LeadLock — the software product

A wedding-specific lead-management system for the pre-client stage: customizable inquiry forms, instant text and email follow-up, nurture sequences, online scheduling and reminders, landing pages, chat widgets, reputation management, a pipeline dashboard, a consolidated communications hub, and traffic-source attribution. Setup fees start at $1,697 and vary by project scope; an ongoing subscription of $147/month maintains platform access, plus messaging fees. LeadLock is built on HighLevel, and they say so openly — "Yes, we built LeadLock on HighLevel - and we're proud of it" — positioning the value in the wedding-specific workflows, templates, and hands-on support layered on top. An early "Founding Member" cohort holds lifetime access on permanently grandfathered terms.

Delivery model, fulfillment policies, and operations

Delivery is fully virtual. Engagements are application-gated rather than open-enrolment: an application and fit review come first, approval typically within 48 business hours, then contract, invoice, and a client questionnaire; project delivery begins no sooner than two weeks out so the team can prepare. Campaign builds are followed by a 72-hour monitoring window and a review call two weeks later. Scarcity is part of the offer design at every tier.

Operationally, the machinery is documented but manual. Everything runs on step-by-step ClickUp boards with templates for every stage — clear frameworks, clear order of operations. Execution, however, is by hand, and the project chain is full of contingencies: when one task slips, the delay dominoes through everything downstream. The firm's stated differentiator — the same framework, but every touchpoint of communication fully personalised to each client's brand and messaging, "never cookie cutter" — is also the step that resists delegation and makes the workflow cumbersome.

Day-to-day coordination runs through an executive assistant (via the Dot staffing service, about 25 hours per week): fielding and answering client communication on the founders' behalf, tasking the team as things come up, and driving the onboarding machinery — structuring each client's Google Drive, filing call recordings, drafting templates, and moving everything along. The founders describe this layer as admin work, but admin with a level of per-client customisation they have not yet found a way to automate.

Published policies: The agency's own terms are thin — no refund, cancellation, or payment terms are published. The product's terms are the opposite: all sales final, auto-renewal after trials, cancellation effective only at the end of the billing cycle, and customers advised to export contact data before cancelling. No service-level or uptime commitments are published on either side.

Thought leadership & content engine

The defining feature is a deliberate absence. There is no blog, no newsletter, and no owned content library — fully consistent with their own doctrine that wedding pros don't need content marketing. The website is a small set of funnel pages, and nearly every button on the homepage routes to a single lead-capture popup for their flagship magnet.

A) Lead magnets

The Ads Investment Guide — a 12-page, quarterly-refreshed PDF ("Q2 2026") carrying their philosophy, budget guidance, and full pricing. A venue case study — an all-inclusive wedding venue in the mountains of Tennessee, combining Google, Meta, and LeadLock. "The Proven Inquiry Funnel" — the exact automated texts and emails that help venues book more weddings. And LeadLock's "Speed to Lead" guide.

B) Podcast appearances / guest circuit

Authority is built on other people's audiences. Confirmed appearances include Evolve Your Wedding Business (episode 302 — the richest single account of their methods and results), Wedding Pro CEO (episode 236), The Venue Rx, Engage Your Brand (episode 37), The Venue Success Podcast, and "Paid Ads 101 for Wedding Pros."

C) Summit teaching

For the Book More Weddings Summit they contributed a beginner's guide and step-by-step workbook for building a Google search campaign.

Partnerships & tools (public alignments)

HighLevel: The foundation of LeadLock, disclosed proudly rather than concealed. Their differentiation claim is the wedding-specific layer built on top.

Google & Meta: The operating platforms, carried with explicit non-affiliation disclaimers. Neither a Google Partner nor a Meta Business Partner badge appears anywhere — notable for a paid-media specialist.

Aisle Planner: A client, evidenced by a named testimonial — a wedding-software company choosing WIA for its own advertising, arguably the strongest peer endorsement in their public record.

Planning Pod / ILEA: Planning Pod appears in their featured-in strip; the International Live Events Association's San Antonio chapter is the sole industry-association marker.

Dot: The staffing service through which their executive assistant is engaged.

Lead Connect: The cited research source behind LeadLock's speed-to-lead statistics.

Tech/stack signals (from public site cues)

Both weddingindustryads.com and leadlockpro.com run entirely on GoHighLevel — the agency operates its own business on the same platform it white-labels for clients. Project management and SOPs live in ClickUp. Collateral is produced in Canva and delivered through Google Drive. Analytics is Google Tag Manager. Internal AI usage is limited to a ChatGPT account and a handful of self-built custom GPTs; there is no automation or agent tooling anywhere in the operation — the workflows are documented, but human-executed end to end.

Team & delivery footprint

The founders are the only W-2 employees; everyone else is a part-time contractor, and no team member beyond the founders is named publicly — there is no team page, despite client testimonials repeatedly praising "your entire team." The delivery bench:

Giselle: Executive assistant through Dot, approaching her one-year anniversary, capped around 25 hours/week and serving other Dot clients. Described by Whitney as "my proxy" — the person who understands her expectations and how the firm should operate. She fields client communication, tasks the team, and runs onboarding end to end.

Carmen and Jacqueline: The Google/Meta ad specialists — "strategist experts in their own right" — who do the hands-on campaign and funnel work. Each gives WIA about 20 hours a week at most, alongside their own businesses.

Tina: A team member entering a season of greater availability, noted as excited about leveraging new tools for efficiency.

The account-manager seat is the structural weak point. The most recent hire, Fallon, joined in May as the first person operating at Whitney's level across Google, Meta, and GoHighLevel — positioned to own the full-service accounts so Whitney could shift to sales and marketing — and gave notice in August, three months in. It is a repeating pattern: a promising contractor is groomed toward a first-employee role, life changes on their end, and the knowledge walks out the door, returning Whitney to client delivery and retraining. The firm has an open posting for a Google and Meta Ads Strategist. Both founders also run their own separate agencies alongside WIA — three businesses across two people — which keeps capacity permanently tight.

Selected public-facing results / outcomes

Examples of outcomes attributed to their work include:

Venue client: Approximately a 13× return on ad spend after five months — their headline story, told in interviews.

Across clients: A consistent 3–4× return on ad spend, varying with business type, market position, and growth goals.

Alyssa (client, role unstated): "December I had THE MOST inquiries in a single month, ever! And it was a lights-out sales month! For January, if we keep pace, I'll have double the inquiries from last January."

Testimonial themes: Six first-name testimonials, uniformly qualitative — responsiveness, communication, back-end wedding-industry knowledge, and "100% worth the money to have WIA do this for us." What clients praise is the hand-holding as much as the numbers.

No named-client case study with attributed metrics is public; the Tennessee venue case study is promoted as "breaking down all the numbers," which sit behind a lead-capture form.

Credibility markers & third-party profiles (signals)

The primary credibility asset is an "As Featured In" wall of fourteen placements across the wedding-education circuit: The Unfiltered Entrepreneur, Wedding Pro CEO Summit, The High-End Wedding Summit, Irresistible Selling Summer School Series, Academy Pro, Wedding Summit Series (and its Luxury Edition), The Venue Rx Podcast, Planning Pod, Evolve Your Wedding Business, Book More Weddings Virtual Summit, I Do Wedding Marketing Podcast, The Wedding Pro CEO Podcast, and ILEA San Antonio. These placements evidence genuine network reach within the industry's educator ecosystem, though they are relationship-driven rather than editorially vetted.

Beyond that wall, external validation is thin: no platform partner badges, no third-party reviews (Clutch, G2, Trustpilot, BBB), no awards or editorial press, and a modest ~1,200-follower Instagram presence — the latter entirely consistent with their own doctrine that follower counts are not the goal. The adverse record is clean: no negative press, litigation, or public complaints. The Aisle Planner client relationship stands out as the strongest single marker, and it sits quietly in a testimonial carousel.

"Needles in the haystack" (unexpected or buried public items)

A) The mobile call-to-action leads to a dead page

The homepage's mid-page "YES, I'M READY!" button exists in two versions. On desktop it opens the Investment Guide capture popup and works as intended. On phones, the mobile-only version links to a deleted funnel step (/ads-consultation94) and lands visitors on a bare 404 — invisible from a desktop, which is presumably why it has survived.

B) The gated guide — and the pricing inside it — is publicly reachable

The Investment Guide's delivery page can be opened directly without completing the form, and it links to a Google Drive file with open link permissions containing the complete price list. The lead capture that nearly every homepage button funnels into can be bypassed in one step.

C) The website and the sales guide describe different offers

The site sells "Elevate" and a three-month Accelerator; the Investment Guide never uses the word "Elevate," splits the Accelerator into two platform products plus a bundle, and promises six months of support. A prospect reading both encounters different product names, counts, and durations.

D) Stale copy lives on both properties

A live booking page still reads "© 2023 Wedding Industry Ads." The LeadLock homepage opens with "so here's the reality in 2025…" while its footer auto-updates to 2026. One live page spells "peace of mind" as "piece of mind."

E) Three businesses, two people

Neither founder works on WIA exclusively: Whitney maintains her own Meta-ads practice, and Daniela operates DEJA — the agency where the partnership actually began. Nothing on WIA's site mentions either.

F) A productising instinct runs through everything

One-day VIP Days became multi-month Accelerators. An internal funnel system became LeadLock, a priced product with founding members. The agency repeatedly turns its own service work into packaged, owned assets — the same instinct that produced their white-label layer on HighLevel.

Consolidated description

Wedding Industry Ads, LLC (weddingindustryads.com) is a two-founder, all-women boutique advertising agency, founded in 2022 and run virtually from Texas, serving the wedding industry exclusively — mostly venues, plus planners, photographers, and entertainers. Whitney Hodges (Liberty Hill; a decade in luxury event sales before Meta ads) and Daniela Justus (Lubbock; an artist turned advertiser who also runs her own agency, DEJA) met in 2020 and built WIA around a distinctive thesis: wedding clients book once and never return, so what a wedding business needs is not followers or content but an evergreen client acquisition system — Google and Meta ads feeding a fast, personalised inquiry funnel.

The offer stack expresses that thesis at three price points: Elevate, a waitlisted full-service retainer averaging $2,500/month including ad spend for roughly a dozen clients; the Ads Accelerators, guided three-to-six-month launches at $1,997–$3,197 that grew out of 2024's one-day VIP Days; and LeadLock, their white-labelled HighLevel product at $1,697+ setup and $147/month. Public credibility rests on a fourteen-placement podcast and summit circuit, a claimed 13× best-case and 3–4× typical return on ad spend, and a peer endorsement from software company Aisle Planner — while the operation behind it runs on two W-2 founders, part-time contractors capped at 20–25 hours, and thoroughly documented but hand-executed ClickUp processes, where deep per-client personalisation is both the differentiator and the bottleneck. Repeated account-manager turnover — most recently a May hire who

resigned in August — keeps pulling the founders back into delivery, and institutional knowledge still lives in individual heads rather than in a system the firm owns.